09-21 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle Schools Offer Basic Cooking and Life-Skill Classes?

① Imagine a Grade-9 student who can solve quadratic equations and read a 1 000-word English passage, but **cannot fry an egg, sew on a button, or safely change a dead light bulb**. This is not a joke; in a recent city survey, over **70 %** of Chinese middle-school students admitted that they had never cooked a full meal on their own. In response, some schools have begun offering a new kind of class — **Basic Cooking and Life-Skill Class**. Supporters are excited. Critics are uneasy. **Should this kind of class become a regular part of middle-school education?**

② Those in favour argue that such classes **fill a real gap**. For decades, Chinese middle schools have focused almost entirely on exams. Yet life after graduation is not only exams; it is also meals to cook, clothes to wash, and small repairs to make. A student who spends six years learning geometry but never boils a pot of rice is, supporters say, a little **strangely educated**. A one-hour "life-skill" class each week could teach cooking, basic tidying, ironing, **first aid**, money management, and how to read a food label — none of which are likely to be taught at home in every family.

③ A second argument is about **independence**. Many middle-school students today live with **very protective parents**; the parents believe "you just study, we do the rest." The result is a new word the newspapers use often: **"adult babies"**, university students who return home because they cannot live on their own. Life-skill classes at school let a student **practise** — safely, under a teacher's eye — the small actions of daily life, so that when one day they rent a tiny flat in a new city for work or university, they feel **prepared**, not panicked.

④ Opponents, however, warn that school time is **already full**. Adding another subject means either lengthening the school day, or cutting time from another subject, such as English or maths. Parents preparing their children for Zhongkao may see a cooking class as a **distraction**. Critics also argue that teaching life skills is **the family's job**, not the school's. If a school takes over every small responsibility of the parent, parents may, in turn, **care even less**, and the problem will quietly grow.

⑤ There is also a **safety and cost** question. A proper cooking class needs a kitchen, gas stoves, sharp knives and a specially trained teacher. A poorly run life-skill class — for example, thirty students and one teacher in a crowded room full of hot oil — could be **more dangerous than useful**. Schools in poorer areas may struggle to afford such

facilities, and a national rule that demands these classes could create new **unfairness** between rich and poor schools.

⑥ My own view is that the **aim is right, but the design must be careful**. Life skills should be part of every middle-school life, but not necessarily as a big, graded new subject. A more gentle form — for example, **one 40-minute practical lesson every two weeks**, combined with a **small "home project"** (record the three meals you cook for your family each month, or keep a simple monthly budget of your pocket money) — could achieve most of the benefit without much pressure on exam subjects. Safety would be managed by **small-group teaching**, outside qualified teachers, and clear, simple equipment rather than fancy gas kitchens.

⑦ **Parents, too, are part of the answer.** Schools cannot and should not replace families. A school can teach how to fry eggs safely; it cannot teach the quiet, daily habit of helping at home. But a life-skill class can give parents a gentle push and a fresh topic for Sunday mornings: *"Show me what you learned this week, and let's cook together."*

⑧ Exams measure a narrow band of skills, but life after school is a wide country. A student who can read, write, cook a simple dinner, stitch a button, and use a fire extinguisher without fear is not only **better prepared for emergencies**, but **more confident in ordinary life**. A school that can give this, along with strong academic teaching, is preparing not only for Zhongkao, but for **the other thirty years afterwards**. That, in the end, is what education is really for.

注释： quadratic equation 一元二次方程；first aid 急救；adult baby 巨婴；fire extinguisher 灭火器；budget 预算

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Which problem does the opening paragraph highlight?

A. Middle-school students cannot solve quadratic equations.
B. Many middle-school students can handle academic tasks but lack basic life skills — a survey showed over 70 % had never cooked a full meal; the question is whether life-skill classes should become regular.
C. Most Chinese families cannot cook.
D. Cooking is illegal for students.

2. According to Paragraph 2, what would a one-hour life-skill class each week teach?

A. Only advanced French cooking for competition.
B. A mix of cooking, basic tidying, ironing, first aid, money management, and how to read a food label.
C. How to memorize a 1 000-word English article.
D. How to pass the Zhongkao physics exam.

3. Why do opponents worry about adding a life-skill subject (Paragraph 4)?

A. Because life skills are not useful in adult life.
B. Because school time is already full, parents worried about Zhongkao may see it as a distraction, and teaching life skills is mostly the family's job.
C. Because only rich families need life skills.
D. Because it would make students too independent too quickly.

4. What careful design does the writer suggest in Paragraph 6?

A. A big graded new subject every single day.
B. Keep a traditional school time-table completely unchanged.
C. One 40-minute practical lesson every two weeks, a small home project, small-group teaching with qualified teachers and simple equipment.
D. Replace maths and English with cooking.

5. Which sentence best matches the writer's final view (Paragraph 8)?

A. Exams are the only thing education should care about.
B. Life skills are more important than academic study.
C. A school that teaches both strong academics and basic life skills prepares students not only for Zhongkao but for "the other thirty years afterwards".
D. Students should stop going to school and learn only cooking.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】段落主旨题
【定位】第①段 "over 70 % had never cooked a full meal ... Should this kind of class become a regular part"
【解析】首段以数据引出"是否应开设生活技能课"议题。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "cooking, basic tidying, ironing, first aid, money management, and how to read a food label"
【解析】支持方设想的课程内容多元。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "school time is already full ... distraction ... family's job"
【解析】反对方担心挤占时间及家庭责任外推。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】作者观点题
【定位】第⑥段 "one 40-minute practical lesson every two weeks ... small home project ... small-group teaching"
【解析】作者主张温和而谨慎的设计。A、B、D 均不符。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第⑧段 "preparing not only for Zhongkao, but for the other thirty years afterwards"
【解析】末段强调教育应兼顾学业与生活技能，着眼长远。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。